



SMARTPHONES

Before you fall prey to smartphone marketing jargon, read this!

Sushant Talwar | sushant@digit.in

Buying a smartphone is not always a straightforward task. More often than not, the buyer needs to navigate through a sea of misleading specifications, technical jargon, and worse, gimmicky features that promise the moon and the stars, but in reality, offer very little value to the end user. Here's a look at some features that you need to be wary of while buying a phone to ensure you get the best value for your money on your next purchase.

Vapour cooling chamber

Vapour Cooling has emerged as one of the latest buzzwords in smartphone marketing these days, with pretty much every new phone promised to come to great cooling performance thanks to the presence of a "large vapour cooling chamber" inside its frame. While it's a good addition to



a smartphone's feature set, it's only of use if done right. As many have learned the hard way, the promise of a vapour-cooling solution alone is no guarantee of good thermals. Rather, it's the size, and the materials used in the making of this chamber that is responsible for keeping your device cool and breezy. So the next time you're getting yourself a new phone, and are close to being swayed into making a buying decision based on the promise of a "large vapour cooling chamber", remember to do a little research and do not make the mistake of simply falling for marketing talk.

Ray tracing

Qualcomm recently jumped on the Ray Tracing bandwagon by launching its first chipset capable of supporting hardware-level ray tracing on smartphones. With it, the chip maker joined Samsung and MediaTek who also have powerful SoCs in the market that supports this advanced light-handling technology for video games. This move has led to a lot of talk about how ray tracing on smartphones will now propel gaming on smartphones to the next level.

While the technology itself is very impressive, and in the long run will result in better graphical effects in games, floating the idea that it will fundamentally change gaming experiences on smartphones, and that too any time soon, is not accurate. Given that even consoles and PCs are still only using ray tracing to not render entire frames but only section of the frame means that we are likely to see a similar performance-focused approach on smartphones as well, which on a small smartphone screen may not end up adding much value when it comes to making games look more real. On that note, might we add that all these are conversations for the future because currently there are no games on smartphones that can take advantage of chip-level ray tracing.

Don't fall prey to the high megapixel count

While a 108MP camera or a 200MP camera on a phone sounds cool, it doesn't always mean better pictures. Most of the time, it's just marketing talk meant to give us the illusion that photos from a higher megapixel

